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BLOG

Turn a Novel or Webnovel into an AI Micro-Drama

By invideo

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A dark, grainy video thumbnail with a silhouette of a person standing in the center. The text 'Novel to AI Microdrama' is overlaid in white serif font.

Novel to AI Microdrama

TL ; DR

To adapt a novel into an AI micro-drama, map each chapter (or half-chapter) to one 60–120-second episode, cut everything that isn't a scene with visible action or dialogue, and load the whole adapted script into a creative producer agent inside invideo so it holds the entire arc. The storyboard agent then breaks each episode into shots without losing continuity across the season.

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Scripting

every passage that isn't visible action or spoken dialogue, and load the full adapted script into a creative producer agent inside invideo. Because the invideo agent holds the entire arc, a storyboard agent can then break each episode into shots without losing continuity across the season. This page covers the adaptation path specifically; for the full production pipeline, start with our AI micro-drama guide.

The adaptation ratio

The working rule: **one chapter equals one episode of 60–120 seconds**. A dense chapter — two locations, a reveal, a fight — splits into two episodes; a thin transitional chapter merges with its neighbor. Documented micro-drama episodes run approximately 1.5 to 2 minutes, so a 10-chapter arc maps cleanly to a 10-episode season, which is exactly the volume a first run should target: one documented series shipped 10 episodes in 3 days with a 3-person crew at \$1,000 per episode. Web-novel source material fits this format unusually well because webnovel chapters are already written to end on a hook — keep each chapter's cliffhanger as the episode's final beat rather than resolving it early.

Adapting for volume matters more than adapting for fidelity. As invideo's creative team puts it: "For a Microdrama studio, the game isn't only a great script. It's shipping enough of them, fast enough, to find your winner as soon as possible." Treat the first season as a test of which arc from your IP lands, not as a definitive adaptation. An AI movie maker from script — where the platform reads the adapted script and generates the shots — is what makes that per-chapter cadence sustainable.

Cutting for visible action

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Interior monologue converts to a visible reaction, a spoken line to another character, or gets cut. Micro-drama has no room for narration-heavy passages.

Exposition and backstory compress into one line of dialogue or one establishing image — never a scene of their own.

Physical description doesn't become screen time at all; it becomes reference material (character sheets, location references) that keeps generations consistent.

Budget dialogue per generation, not per scene. Cramming too much dialogue into a single 15-second generation breaks pacing and reduces your editor's control — split long exchanges across multiple shots so each generation carries one or two lines.

Load the adapted script into a creative producer agent

Once the season is adapted, upload the complete script plus a short show bible (tone, characters, world rules pulled from the novel) into a creative producer agent inside invideo, using its notebook as the single source of truth. The principle from invideo's creative team: "Show Bible = single source of truth. Locked scripts = execution mode." Because this agent holds all ten episodes at once, it knows a prop planted in episode 2 pays off in episode 8 — continuity the source novel already contains stays intact.

From there, spin up a director sub-agent per episode, each with its own notebook, all pulling from the same central context — the full script-to-episode workflow covers this step by step. A storyboard agent then breaks each episode script into a shot-by-shot plan that doubles as your shooting schedule. Central context also absorbs your novel's mid-arc changes: "Mid-series change like a scar or a haircut? Update the context once, the Agent remembers for every episode." Update the character's entry when the source material changes them, and every subsequent episode inherits it.

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Yes. Map each chapter to one 60–120-second episode, cut everything that isn't visible action or dialogue, and load the adapted season script into a creative producer agent inside invideo so it holds the full arc. A 3-person crew shipped a 10-episode series this way in 3 days at \$1,000 per episode.

How many chapters per episode?

One chapter per episode is the baseline, at 60–120 seconds of runtime. Split dense chapters into two episodes and merge thin transitional chapters with their neighbors. Keep each chapter's ending hook as the episode cliffhanger.

Watch these to see the techniques in action:

How to make Microdramas with AI Agents (Filmmaking Guide)

Invideo for Filmmaking



Watch on

Full guide: turning scripts into micro-drama episodes with the invideo agent

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